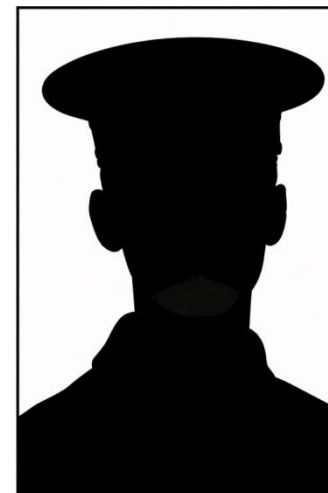
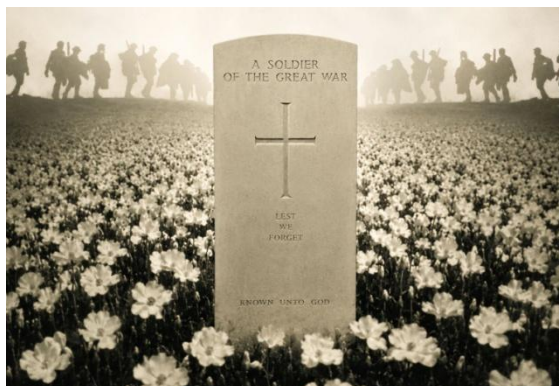




Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford

1894 – 1917

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford	CWGC https://www.cwgc.org/find-records/find-war-dead/casualty-details/846396/reginald-edwin-cecil-ashford/
Date of Birth	C1894 Fulham	
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	30/10/1917	CWGC
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	23	
Marital Status	Not found a marriage listed online and no mention in next of kin	
Children (if any)		
Occupation prior to Call up	Not found one listed anywhere	

Parents	Edwin Charles and Mabel Elizabeth Ashford, of 37, Salisbury Rd., Harrow-on-the-Hill	CWGC
Listed Address(s)	119 Vaughan Road, Harrow	1911 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Tailor's Manager at a Tailors	
Brothers and Sisters	Aubrey Charles (older), Edith M (younger) and 2 siblings who died	1911 census
Years at John Lyon School	Listed as a scholar aged 16 in 1911 census	1911 census
University (if any)		
Obituary	Unable to find an obituary in any newspapers	
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	Harrow on the Hill war memorial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340001
	John Lyon School plaque	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340956
	John Lyon School sundial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/341247
	There is more than one Artists' Rifles memorial but I don't know if he's on them as I haven't found a list or image	

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	ASHFORD R.E.C.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/846396/ashford,-reginald-edwin-cecil/
Age	23
DoD	30-Oct-17
Rank	L Cpl
Regiment	London Regiment (Artists' Rifles) 1st/28th Bn
	TYNE COT MEMORIAL
Location	West-Vlaanderen, Belgium
Military details	Son of Edwin Charles and Mabel Elizabeth Ashford, of 37, Salisbury Rd., Harrow-on-the-Hill, Middlesex.

Story of Scarifice

Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford (1894 – 1917)

Reginald Ashford was born in Parsons Green, Fulham in 1894. He was the son of Edwin Charles and Mabel Elizabeth Ashford. By 1911 the family was living at 119 Vaughan Road, Harrow. His father, Edwin Charles Ashford, worked as a tailor's manager. Reginald had an older brother, Aubrey Charles, a younger sister, Edith M., and two other siblings who had died.

Civilian Life

In 1911, when he was recorded as aged 16, Reginald was a scholar at John Lyon School. The research does not identify an occupation for him before his military service, nor does it establish that he attended university. There is also no marriage or children recorded in the research. No newspaper obituary has been found. His connection with John Lyon School is preserved in several memorial records. His name appears on the Harrow-on-the-Hill war memorial and on memorials associated with John Lyon School, including a school plaque and sundial.

Military Life

During the First World War, Reginald served in the London Regiment, Artists' Rifles, 1st/28th Battalion. He attained the rank of Lance Corporal. Reginald served in France and Flanders.

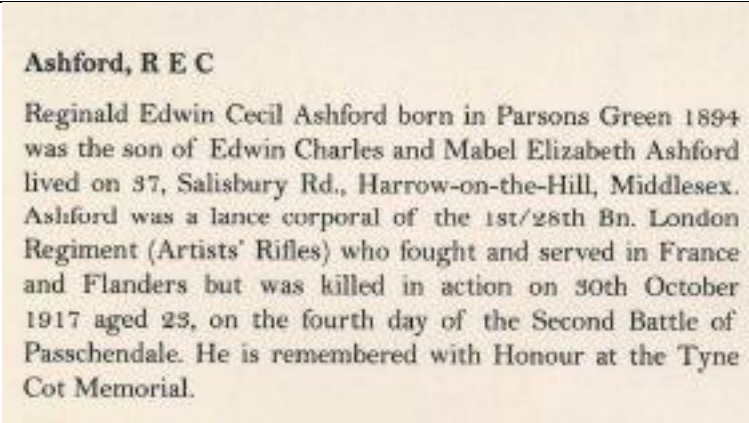
On October 30, 1917, Lance Corporal Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford was killed during the Second Battle of Passchendaele (part of the Third Battle of Ypres) in Belgium. The attack was launched at 5:50 am in pitch darkness. Just as the men went "over the top," the German artillery unexpectedly shifted their defensive barrage line directly onto the British assembly positions. The Artists' Rifles suffered terrible casualties in the opening seconds of the battle and immediately lost contact with their own advancing artillery screen. The battlefield had been turned into a swamp by months of shelling and torrential rain. The Artists' Rifles attempted to advance toward a German strongpoint called Source Trench. Men became bogged down knee-deep in thick mud, making them easy targets. Many wounded men tragically drowned in water-filled shell craters. Hidden German concrete pillboxes opened up with devastating, close-range machine-gun fire. During this specific advance, one entire company of the Artists' Rifles was completely annihilated. Reginald has no known grave and is listed on the Tyne Cot Memorial for the missing, he was killed in action during the initial charge or the chaotic shelling that pinned the battalion down all day. In the muddy chaos of Passchendaele, hundreds of bodies could not be recovered or identified. Out of 470 Artists' Rifles who went into the attack that morning, 350 became casualties, with 170 of them killed. Because Ashford has no known grave, his name is commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial in West Vlaanderen, Belgium.

At the date of his death, Ashford's parents were living at 37 Salisbury Road, Harrow-on-the-Hill, Middlesex, they were later recorded at 37 Salisbury Road, Harrow-on-the-Hill.

Footnote

In July 1947, during the post-World War II restructuring of the Territorial Army, the Artists Rifles was reconstituted and renamed as the 21st Special Air Service Regiment (Artists Rifles). The number "21" was intentionally chosen by reversing the numbers of the two disbanded wartime regular regiments, 1 SAS and 2 SAS, to preserve their lineage.

Notes and Clippings

Anniversary Pupil research 2014	
 Ashford, R E C Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford born in Parsons Green 1894 was the son of Edwin Charles and Mabel Elizabeth Ashford lived on 37, Salisbury Rd., Harrow-on-the-Hill, Middlesex. Ashford was a lance corporal of the 1st/28th Bn. London Regiment (Artists' Rifles) who fought and served in France and Flanders but was killed in action on 30th October 1917 aged 23, on the fourth day of the Second Battle of Passchendaele. He is remembered with Honour at the Tyne Cot Memorial.	Ashford, R E C Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford, born in Parsons Green in 1894, was the son of Edwin Charles and Mabel Elizabeth Ashford. He lived at 37 Salisbury Road, Harrow-on-the-Hill, Middlesex. Ashford was a Lance Corporal of the 1st/28th Battalion, London Regiment (Artists' Rifles), who fought and served in France and Flanders, but was killed in action on 30th October 1917, aged 23, on the fourth day of the Second Battle of Passchendaele. He is remembered with Honour at the Tyne Cot Memorial.

No available independent documented research has been found so the following is generated by A.I.

AI view on his death

"Lance Corporal Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford was killed in action on October 30, 1917, during World War I. He was 23 years old. [1] Because he died during intense fighting in the Ypres Salient but has no known grave, his name is engraved on the [Tyne Cot Memorial](#).

- Roll of Honour 1914-1918 - The Artists Rifles Association

The Artists Rifles Association

- Lance Corporal Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford

On October 30, 1917, Lance Corporal Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford was killed during the Second Battle of Passchendaele (part of the Third Battle of Ypres) in Belgium. [1, 2]

The [Great War Forum](#) and historical regimental logs detail the devastating conditions and actions of the 1st/28th Battalion London Regiment (Artists' Rifles) on that specific day: [1, 2]

The Disaster at Zero Hour

The attack was launched at 5:50 am in pitch darkness. Just as the men went "over the top," the German artillery unexpectedly shifted their defensive barrage line directly onto the British assembly positions. The Artists' Rifles suffered terrible casualties in the opening seconds of the battle and immediately lost contact with their own advancing artillery screen. [1, 2]

Knee-Deep Mud and Heavy Machine-Gun Fire

The battlefield had been turned into a swampland by months of shelling and torrential rain. The Artists' Rifles attempted to advance toward a German strongpoint called Source Trench. [1, 2, 3]

- The Quagmire: The men became bogged down knee-deep in thick mud, making them easy targets. Many wounded men tragically drowned in water-filled shell craters. [1, 2]
- The Slaughter: Hidden German concrete pillboxes opened up with devastating, close-range machine-gun fire. During this specific advance, one entire company of the Artists' Rifles was completely annihilated. [1, 2]

How Reginald Died

Because Reginald has no known grave and is listed on the Tyne Cot Memorial for the missing, he was killed in action during the initial charge or the chaotic shelling that pinned the battalion down all day. In the muddy chaos of Passchendaele, hundreds of bodies could not be recovered or identified. Out of 470 Artists' Rifles who went into the attack that morning, 350 became casualties, with 170 of them killed. [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

